My remarks to the IIM students were not situated in the ‘here and now’ context; my intent was to convey to them the broader dilemma of making a judgement call on a complex policy issue. The media would have none of it. They interpreted my comments as further policy tightening in the upcoming end-January policy review, and the news was on the wire agency tickers even before I finished speaking. Several of our usual interlocutors chided me for not realizing that that there was no question of the governor ever speaking ‘in an academic context’.

And finally, I learnt of the need to shape my message better to ensure fuller and accurate coverage. For example, at the BANCON 2010, an annual bankers’ conference, I focused my comments on the efficiency of the Indian banking system, while covering a host of issues, including the relative efficiency of public and private banks, their asset-liability management, credit standards and customer service, as well as the use of technology. In passing, I made a comment on the salary structure of public sector bank chiefs and said that it needs to be reviewed in order to attract talent.

I was perplexed by how the media reporting made it look like I had devoted the entire speech to bemoaning the salary structure of public sector bank CEOs and how, in my view, fixing it was critical to improving the efficiency of the Indian banking system. The *Mint*, in its edition of 8 September 2010, reported on my speech with the bold headline: ‘Subbarao favours higher salaries for chiefs of state-run banks’. In follow-up articles and opinion pieces, there was extensive comparative analysis of the salary structure of public, private and foreign bank CEOs. Some lateral-thinking media analysts even put the measly salary of the Reserve Bank governor in their comparative charts. In an analytical piece titled ‘RBI Governor earns less than 5 percent of top paid bankers’, the *Economic Times* of 5 September 2010 wrote: ‘In an irony of sorts, RBI gets to approve the salaries of all top level bankers in the country but the central bank’s top officials themselves get less than 5 percent of what is paid to bank chiefs.’ Admittedly, much of this reporting was constructive, but I still felt that the